

Market Maker Warfare

How the whole thing works — the briefing room, the campaign, and the three steps you now have to take before you are allowed to pull the trigger.

The one idea behind the game

External structure — the big swing highs and lows — tells you where price went. It always looks tidy afterwards, and it is always history.

Internal structure is what happened *inside* the leg on the way there: the low that got taken and handed straight back, the break that was never a break. That is where the manipulation lives, and that is what you are here to learn to see.

So the game will not let you trade until you have said out loud what the inside is doing. Ask first. Observe second. Execute third.

1 The briefing room

The front page. Seven short lessons, ten questions each. You need **7 out of 10** to pass one, and each is locked until you have passed the one before it. Pass all seven and the campaign opens.

Candles	What one bar is actually telling you. Why only the close counts.
Levels	Horizontal lines, and why price remembers them.
Trend Lines	The diagonal, and where it lies to you.
Moving Averages	SMA, EMA, and the lag you cannot remove.
Market Structure	Highs, lows, and the moment a trend actually turns.
Indicators	What they are, and exactly how far to trust them.
Risk & R	The arithmetic that decides whether any of this pays.

You can retake any lesson as often as you like. Your best score sticks.

2 The campaign map

Thirty numbered operations in five ranks, then it keeps going forever. Each operation is a real stretch of market that actually happened — no invented prices anywhere in the game.

Rank	Operations
RECRUIT	1 – 6
OPERATOR	7 – 12
VETERAN	13 – 18
WARLORD	19 – 24
MARKET MAKER	25 – 30
MARKET MAKER ∞	31 and past it, forever

Pick your timeframe before you deploy

At the top of the map there is an **Execution** row with three buttons. This is the bar size you will actually be trading.

1H Fast. The 4H sits above it as your bias.

4H Slower and wider. The daily sits above it.

1D Slowest. The weekly sits above it.

It is the same hours underneath either way — just grouped bigger. The structure gets slower and cleaner as you step up, and the questions the game asks you are always read off the timeframe you picked.

The market rotates as you climb — MES (S&P 500), MNQ (Nasdaq 100) and MGC (gold) — so you are not only ever practising one thing.

3 The three steps

This is the heart of it. Every burst of trading is gated behind a read. You cannot skip it and you cannot fast-forward past it.

STEP ONE — ASK

The clock stops. The chart goes **completely plain** — no lines, no labels, just candles, exactly as it would look live.

One question appears under the chart, about what is happening inside the leg running right now. You pick an answer.

Nothing is rushing you. Time left does not tick down, and the ghost unit is frozen too, so it cannot get ahead of you while you think.

STEP TWO — OBSERVE

Your answer turns green if you had it and red if you did not. The correct one lights green either way, and a sentence tells you *why* it was the answer.

Then the chart draws what was actually there. This is the part that teaches you — you guessed blind, now you see the truth over the top of your guess.

A correct read pays **\$60**. Three correct in a row and it pays **\$120** each while the streak holds.

STEP THREE — EXECUTE

Press **Step three — execute**. The clock starts, FIRE LONG and FIRE SHORT unlock, and you get **12 bars** of live trigger.

When the 12 bars run out it locks and asks again. Close a trade and it locks immediately — straight back to step one.

The top bar shows where you are: **reads 3/5 · trigger live 8 bars**.

What the chart draws in step two

HH HL LH LL

The big turns. Green when price is building higher highs and higher lows, red when it is breaking down. This is the **external** structure.

Two dotted lines

The last major high and the last major low, labelled *stops above* and *stops below*. That is where other people's money is sitting.

Shaded band

The leg running right now. Green band means the leg is up, red means down.

Purple dots

The small swings **inside** that leg. This is the internal structure — the thing the questions are about.

Yellow mark	SWEPT · given back. Price took a level and handed it straight back. That is a raid on the stops, not a break.
Orange mark	BROKE · held. Price closed through and stayed there. That is a real break — structure changed.
Bottom line	Reads it out in words, e.g. <i>LEG UP · INSIDE: higher lows · OUTSIDE: RANGE.</i>

4 The four questions

It rotates through these so you never get the same one twice running. Every one is answered off the internal structure of *your* timeframe.

Direction	Ignore the big swings. Inside the leg running now, which way are the small highs and lows stepping? — up, down, or chopping.
The level	Price has just been back to a level it already made. What did it do there? — swept and gave it back, or closed through and held.
Agreement	From the outside the structure reads UP. Does the inside of this leg agree, disagree, or has it not said yet?
Liquidity	Which price is the untaken high or low — the one the stops are sitting on?

The third one is the whole edge. When the outside and the inside disagree, the outside is the one about to be wrong. External structure is what already happened. Internal structure is how it is arriving.

5 Firing a trade

Once the trigger is live, three dials decide the shape of the trade. Set them before you fire.

Dial	Choices	What it does
Armour	Tight / Swing / Wide	Where your stop goes, measured off the recent swing. Tight is a small stop and a small target; Wide is the opposite. Swing is the honest default.
Payload	2R / 3R	How far the target sits, as a multiple of what you are risking. 3R pays more but is hit less often.
Size	1× / 2× / 4×	Multiplies the payout and the damage. A 4× trade that fails is four hits at once. This is the only dial that can end a run by itself.

If the swing is too close to price, the game refuses the trade — there is no cover there.

6 What can kill you

Ammo	A fixed number of trades. Six early on, four by the end. Run out and the operation is over.
Armour	A fixed number of losses you can take. Four early on, two by the end.
The clock	A fixed number of bars. Waiting costs you. It only runs during step three.

Nerve	The bar under the scoreboard. It climbs every time you lose. At the top the screen goes red and you are the threat, not the market.
Supply cost	From operation 13 onward, every shot costs a small slice of R whether it wins or not. It doubles on a panic shot.

The two mistakes the game charges you for, out loud

The panic shot. Firing within three bars of a loss. Double supply cost, nerve goes up, and it costs you the third star.

Sizing up while shaken. Going 2× or 4× while your nerve is gone. Same penalty. The game calls it *the sixteen-lot*.

7 The ghost unit

A rival trading the same tape beside you, drawn faintly on your chart as a dashed purple line so you can see what it is doing. You are scored against it at the end. It only moves when bars move — so it is frozen while you are reading.

8 Power-ups

Earned, never bought. Every two three-star clears buys a RECON, every three buys a PLATE. They are not locked behind the read — you can use them any time.

RECON	Shows you five bars into the future, for five bars. Maximum three held.
PLATE	Eats one stop-out whole — the round stops, no damage. Maximum two held.

9 Stars, cash and rank

Stars	What it takes
★■	Clear the operation.
★★■	Clear it taking one hit or none.
★★★	No losses at all, no panic shots, no oversized losses, and you read more than half your questions right.

The read is now part of the perfect run. A clean sweep where you only read half of them gets two stars, and the debrief says so: *“A clean run — but you only read half of them, and that is what cost you the third star.”*

Cash comes from two places: your R on winning trades, multiplied by your win streak — and \$60 for every question you read correctly, whether the trade that followed won or lost. Reading it right pays even on a losing day.

10 Bosses

Every sixth operation. Each punishes one specific mistake, and each hands you one extra round of ammo.

Op	Name	The habit
6	MINEFIELD	Sweeps the stops under you, then runs the other way. Chase the break here and you go home in pieces.
12	ATTRITION	Slow, mean and sideways. It bleeds you one small wound at a time.

Op	Name	The habit
18	CROSSFIRE	Reverses without warning from both sides. A thin stop gets cut in half.
24	AMBUSH	Silence, silence, silence — then one candle that moves a whole day.
30	THE MARKET MAKER	He can see your stop from orbit. Everything at once.

11 The debrief

When the operation ends you are told three things you did not know while you were in it:

- **Which market and when.** Held back until it is over so the name could not colour your read — then handed to you so you can go and pull the real chart up and look.
- **How you did against the ghost unit,** in R.
- **Your read score.** How many of the questions you got right, what the intel paid, and — if you were short — that the trades are not the problem yet, the read is.

Quick reference

Locked trigger? You have not answered the question yet. Scroll to the panel under the chart.

Clock not moving? That is correct — it is stopped for steps one and two.

12 bars of live trigger per read. Closing a trade ends it early.

\$60 a correct read, **\$120** on a streak of three or more.

More than half your reads right, or no third star.

Change your timeframe on the campaign map, not inside an operation.